

TOP PASSENGER EVs LAUNCHED AT **AUTO EXPO 2020**



Mahindra eXUV300

Price: Between ₹ 1 million and ₹ 1.3 million



Tata Altroz EV

Price: ₹ 1 million (approximately)



Mercedes-Benz EQC

Price: ₹ 5 million (approximately)



BMW Ora R1

Price: ₹ 720,000 lakh (approximately)



Mahindra eKUV

Price: ₹ 825,000 (ex-showroom)



Renault City K-ZE

Price: ₹ 1 million (approximately)

Nijhum Rudra

To combat escalating pollution, car companies all over the world are finding solutions to replace conventional vehicles. CNG vehicles have become popular in several countries, but according to car experts, CNG does not prevent pollution completely. A number of solar and electric vehicles (EVs) have been unleashed in few past years. However, so far, only solar-powered e-rickshaws are available in India.

Due to various concerns and challenges, solar vehicles have not gained much popularity,

while EVs have become quite popular in various parts of the world. Many initiatives and investment policies are being undertaken by the government of India to promote EVs in India.

Primary reason behind popularity of EVs and not solar vehicles is that the former has much lower running costs. Moreover, EVs are cheaper to maintain as these do not contain costly automobile parts such as exhaust systems, starter motors, fuel injection systems and radiators. Also, there are many environmental and health benefits of EVs.

Things to consider before buying an EV

The following points should be kept in mind while buying an EV.

Reality. Even though EVs are gaining popularity, these are still not the ideal

choice for everyone because there are various things to consider like number of family members, driving habits and resources. Currently, EVs are considered suitable for young urban people who drive less and do not have to do much highway driving.

Charging. There are not enough charging stations and infrastructure for EVs, especially in India. Hence, travelling long distances is still not possible. Price of charging EV batteries is still quite high, since electricity is quite expensive.

Maintenance. Maintenance cost of EVs could be high especially during a breakdown. As of now, many car mechanics are not aware of proper engineering and parts of EVs. Also, getting parts can sometimes be troublesome and force owners to take their cars to the